the Federal Intelligence Service, called Bundesnachrichtendienst (BND) was established after the enactment of the Federal Intelligence Service Law in 1990. With these examples, the petitioner in India's Supreme Court demanded oversight mechanisms such as accountability to a Parliamentary Committee to ensure that the intelligence agencies function in accordance with the law and the democratic ideals of the nation.

The apex court rejected the petition in 2016, observing that any attempt to get into the domain of intelligence may create a dent in national security. Between the filing of the petition and the judgment, the intelligence community in India seethed with counter arguments that the Indian political condition was not suitable for a Parliamentary oversight. According to a senior intelligence officer code-named Vijay Giri, the country's intelligence organs cannot afford to have political oversight for one simple reason—politicians cannot keep a secret.

'Suppose you wanted $30 million for an operation. Can you expect the political leaders to keep it a secret? It is not fair to compare Indian intelligence agencies with their counterparts in the developed countries. The political atmosphere is very different here and our operations would not survive for even a day. Even in the current scenario, we have unrealistic expectations from the R&AW despite the fact that the decision makers are not letting us work. We are not able to exploit the R&AW's full potential,' said Giri.

In the half a century since its inception in 1968, the R&AW has developed the capability to harvest excellent intelligence with the help of hundreds of analysts, strategists and committed field agents. Indian spies have graduated from sniffing out